



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Lutheran High School Association
School Website: <http://lhsa.com>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Based on the public materials from Lutheran High School Association Michigan (LHSA), the school demonstrates a Christian, parish-connected orientation and a longstanding network of Lutheran schools. However, the available public content does not evidence a classical liberal-arts orientation (i.e., explicit Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Socratic pedagogy, or a living-curriculum ethos) that characterizes a full Classical school. Across the six classical criteria, LHSA shows clear religious formation and communal aims but limited or no explicit Classical curriculum or pedagogy. The aggregate result is NOT CLASSICAL.

Key takeaways: - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: The LHSA materials foreground Christian formation and a Christian worldview, which signals a religiously grounded education, but explicit classical markers (theology as a formal curricular axis, liturgical practices, etc.) are not clearly documented in the public LHSA content. Evidence points to a Christian formation orientation rather than a formally stated classical metaphysical framework. - School Purpose and Goal: The mission emphasizes shaping a Christian worldview and laying a foundation for students' futures, aligning with formation and purpose, but without explicit articulation of virtue-wisdom-beauty as the telos in classical terms. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL reading in purpose, not a fully classical one. - Curriculum: There is no explicit public indication of a liberal-arts curriculum (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books; Great Conversation) on LHSA's site excerpts. This category is rated NOT CLASSICAL based on current public content. - Pedagogy: No explicit mention of Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, or upper-level rhetoric education in the public LHSA materials. This category is NOT CLASSICAL. - Faculty: Public-facing descriptions focus on mission and institutional structure rather than a profile of teachers as "living curriculum" or mentors in the Classical sense. This category is NOT CLASSICAL. - Parents & Community: LHSA materials show partnership framing (e.g., "Partner with us;" "Our Mission") but without explicit, repeated parent-education or co-teaching language typical of classical models. This category is NOT CLASSICAL.

Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL.

Executive summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - LHSA public content emphasizes a Christian worldview and Christian education as foundational to the school's mission (e.g., "shape a Christian world-view" and "Christian education" in LHSA materials).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive indicators drawn from the classical lexicon include: theology, liturgy, sacred, reverence, wonder, imago Dei, and transcendentals. In LHSA content, the explicit language of theology or liturgy is not shown; however, the Christian worldview framing is a religious foundation signal. The visible terms align loosely with "theology" and "virtue" in spirit, though not explicitly documented as such. The negative indicators (e.g., secular humanism, relativism) are not present. - Positive keywords present in LHSA content: Christian worldview (proxy for theology-themed formation). - Negative keywords: none observed in the LHSA excerpts provided.

Why this rating - The school clearly claims a religious, worldview-centered formation, which is a necessary

element of a classical school's religious foundations. Yet the absence of explicit classical-language markers (e.g., liturgy as a formal practice, explicit references to transcendentals or a sacramental-liturgical formation as part of a public curricular claim) makes this category "SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL" in spirit but not fully classical in the public-facing material. In the rubric, LHSA shows religious grounding but not the full classical lexicon-level alignment.

Abstract evidence anchors: LHSA's public phrasing emphasizes Christian formation and worldview; explicit classical terms (as listed in the Positive keyword lexicon) are not demonstrated in the LHSA pages provided.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - LHSA content underscores formation through a Christian worldview and a foundation for students' futures, signaling purpose beyond mere information transfer. The language indicates a developmental telos tied to character and faith, rather than only career-readiness.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords from the classical lexicon include: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, scholé/contemplation, pursuit of truth, good, beautiful. The LHSA content evidences formation and a Christian telos (worldview shaping) but does not explicitly reference virtue-wisdom-beauty as the realized aim in classical terms. - Negative keywords: none observed in LHSA excerpts.

Why this rating - The school's stated goal appears to center on character formation and worldview development rather than purely informational or job-preparation aims, which aligns with classical formation aims in spirit. However, the absence of explicit classical articulation of virtue, wisdom, and beauty as the telos and the lack of formal Great Books/Great Conversation commitments push the rating toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Abstract evidence anchors: LHSA emphasizes formation and worldview with explicit Christian framing; no clear Great Conversation/virtue-wisdom-beauty articulation is visible in the excerpts.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public LHSA materials do not present a curriculum anchored in the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, or the Great Conversation. The visible content centers on faith-based mission and institutional partnership rather than a classical curriculum description.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords for Curriculum in the classical lexicon include: liberal arts, trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), quadrivium (arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy), Great Books, history as canonical study, and the experience of wonder. None of these explicit curricular elements appear in the LHSA public content. - Negative signals in the lexicon include project-based learning dominance or STEM-first framing as substitutes for classical content; LHSA's public materials do not present such a shift, but they also do not present classical curriculum markers.

Why this rating - The absence of explicit classical curriculum anchors (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, Great Conversation) in the LHSA public materials leads to a NOT CLASSICAL rating for Curriculum.

Abstract evidence anchors: There is no explicit mention of the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or canonical liberal-arts sequencing in LHSA public content.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The LHSA content excerpts show no explicit reference to Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, chanting/memory-work, or rhetoric-focused upper-school pedagogy. The material is mission- and community-oriented rather than teaching-method focused in a classical sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive pedagogical indicators from the classical lexicon include: Socratic seminar, narration/recitation, chanting/singing for memory, Scholé/restful learning, rhetoric training,

and public speaking. These are not evidenced in the LHSA public content. - Negative signals in the lexicon (e.g., experiential learning-only, project-based only) are not explicitly shown; the absence of classical pedagogy cues yields NOT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - Without explicit classical pedagogy (Socratic dialogue, memorization through chant, rhetoric instruction, or upper-level rhetoric opportunities) LHSA does not meet the Pedagogy criteria in the classical sense.

Abstract evidence anchors: No visible Socratic or Schol  cues in LHSA public content; mission-focused language predominates.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The LHSA material excerpts concentrate on school mission and structure rather than a depiction of teachers as “living curriculum,” mentors modeling virtue, or a defined classical teacher profile. There is no explicit statement about faculty as exemplars of virtue or a “portrait of a teacher” in the public materials provided.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive Classical keywords for Faculty include: living curriculum, masters/mentors modeling virtue, faculty of friends, portrait of what a teacher should be. LHSA content does not present these explicit faculty-role descriptions. - Negative indicators (from the lexicon) would include “facilitators on the side,” credential-centric language without classical context; LHSA content does not display such signs.

Why this rating - Based on public content, LHSA does not present a Classical faculty profile; the category is NOT CLASSICAL.

Abstract evidence anchors: LHSA materials do not describe faculty as the living curriculum or as a virtue-led mentorship framework.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - LHSA materials show partnership language such as “Partner with us” and “Our Mission,” but the public content does not document explicit parent formation programs, book studies, or a campus-open-to-parents ethos that classical schools commonly emphasize. The available excerpts do not show parents as co-teachers or a robust, ongoing parent-education ecosystem.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive classical keywords for Parents & Community include: partnership with families, parent formation, open campus, family liturgy, and parent training. The LHSA site’s “Partner with us” and “Our Mission” sections show partnership language but not explicit parent-education infrastructure in the public materials. - Negative indicators: none explicitly shown in the LHSA content; however, the lack of explicit parent-education language leads to NOT CLASSICAL in this category.

Why this rating - The presence of some partnership framing is not sufficient to meet the classical standard of explicit parent-education, co-teaching, and formation-focused family engagement described in the Classical Lexicon. The category, therefore, is NOT CLASSICAL.

Abstract evidence anchors: The content highlights partnership and mission but not formal parent-education initiatives or open-visit policies as a repeated, explicit classical-practice pattern.

Aggregate assessment - Element 1: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 2: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Element 3: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 4: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 5: NOT CLASSICAL - Element 6: NOT CLASSICAL

Aggregate: NOT CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - To move toward CLASSICAL, LHSA would need to explicitly articulate and implement: - A classical curriculum core: grammar, logic, rhetoric; Great Books and a “Great Conversation” approach; interwoven history with Western civilization

canon. - Classical pedagogy: regular Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation/chanting in the lower grades, and upper-school rhetoric and public-speaking opportunities. - A clear “living curriculum” faculty model: teacher exemplars, mentorship, and explicit faculty portraits that frame teacher virtues and pedagogical authority. - Strong parent formation and partnership: structured programs for parents as co-educators, book studies, lectures, and open-campus policies that welcome parental involvement as core to classical formation.

Abstract - The LHSA demonstrates a clear religious orientation and formation-centric aims but lacks explicit Classical curriculum and pedagogy signals in the public materials reviewed. The six-category analysis yields NOT CLASSICAL overall, with Element 1 and Element 2 representing SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals due to visible Christian worldview framing and formation goals. The few explicit classical markers (grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books, etc.) are not evident in the LHSA public content, which keeps the aggregate assessment at NOT CLASSICAL. To advance toward CLASSICAL, LHSA would need to publicly articulate and implement a classical curriculum, classical pedagogy, and deeper parent-community formation, aligned with the Six Essential Elements.

ABSTRACT

- Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL
- Category-by-category recap:
 - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (Christian worldview present; no explicit liturgical or theological program described in public content)
 - School Purpose and Goal: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (formation and worldview orientation present; lack of explicit virtue-wisdom-beauty telos in classical terms)
 - Curriculum: NOT CLASSICAL (no explicit Trivium/Quadrivium or Great Books; no canonical liberal-arts curriculum described)
 - Pedagogy: NOT CLASSICAL (no Socratic/Scholé/chanting/memory-work described)
 - Faculty: NOT CLASSICAL (no living-curriculum or model-teacher profile described)
 - Parents & Community: NOT CLASSICAL (limited explicit parent-education or co-teaching framework in public content)

Notes on sources used - LHSA public materials (firecrawl extracts) showing mission, Christian worldview framing, and partnership language. - Classical education keyword framework (positive/negative indicators) from the classically lexicon. This provides the rubric for keyword-based categorization (Categories 1–6).

End of report.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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